When I replied in the negative, he pulled out a paper from his file and started reading out the charges. I had sold sensitive rocket technology to Pakistan. This is an offence under the Official Secrets Act, punishable with a fourteen-year sentence.

Then, pointing to the 'biggest man in IB,' he continued: 'This great man has come all the way to hear it from your mouth. He reports directly to the most powerful person in the country. He has to return to Delhi soon, so you better confess everything now.'

It would occur to me only much later that the 'biggest man in IB' was not really one, it was M K Dhar, the joint director of IB.

Now, I replied calmly: 'I have nothing to tell you than the fact that I am innocent. This must be a misunderstanding.'

'No,' he barked. 'We understand everything clearly. Now, tell us when did you first meet Mariam Rasheeda?'

'I never met her.'

'How dare you lie? She has told us everything. Come on, tell us the truth before we turn brutal. Accept everything or else you are gone.'

'Please believe me,' I said in a matter of fact tone. 'I have never met these Maldivian women you are talking about. I don't even know how they look. How can they say I met them?'

'If you continue to deny, I will bring Fauziyya here and make her slipper you. And that photograph will appear in all the newspapers.'

My mind was racing. What would be their motive? Why would the Maldivian women say they had met me?

The 'biggest man in IB' and his associates soon left, and the prime interrogator continued.

'It is not just those two ladies who have confessed; your subordinate Sasikumaran also has. Now don't try to hide anything.'

'What did you say?' I almost jumped from my chair. 'Sasi has confessed? What is it that he has confessed?'

'So you are worried, Mr Nambi …' he smirked. 'Sasi has told me everything … details of the drawings and documents of rocket science that